Name: _____ Date: _____

Worksheet W5 · W-Seminar "Time"

Research methods

From your working thesis to the information you need – and nothing more.

1 My question – version 2

improve version 1 from W4

spark → question → **working thesis** → testable claim → thesis

Question: _____

Working thesis: _____

_____

Changed since W4 – and why: _____

2 Five refinery questions

Questions your paper must answer so that your thesis can stand. Give each one a job, then check it: **O** = open (no yes/no, no either/or) · **N** = necessary (without it: a gap) · **A** = answerable (sources or own data).

job	my refinery question	O	N	A
1 Define		☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 2				
2 Explain		☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 2				
3 Context		☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 1				
4 Test		☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 3 + 4				
5 Evaluate		☐	☐	☐
→ ch. 5 + 6				

3 From question to search string

for question _____

term	synonym	synonym
concept 1		
concept 2		
concept 3		

My search string: _____

Operators AND · OR · NOT / - · "exact phrase" · ( ) · chrono* · site: · filetype:pdf · intitle:

4 Where I will search

☐ Google Scholar ☐ BASE / CORE / DOAJ ☐ library catalogue (OPAC) ☐ Destatis / Our World in Data
☐ Project Gutenberg / Internet Archive ☐ newspapers (context only) ☐ other: _____

Snowballing: backward = its works cited · forward = "Cited by"

One good source to snowball from: _____

builder + planner

5 My research matrix

Scan → skim → read closely. Note only what answers a question. Mark every note: **[Q]** quote · **[P]** paraphrase · **[!]** own thought – [Q] and [P] always with page.

source (author, year)	Q#	key point (page)	type

6 Check one source: the five Ws

Source: _____

Who? author

Where? publication

What? evidence

When? date

Why? purpose

☐ lateral reading done Verdict: ☐ solid ☐ use with care ☐ avoid

7 Parking lot interesting, but not needed for my five questions